“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 14

The Vṛndāvana Pastimes

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Gaura watched with His companions the festival of Śrī Lakṣmī’s procession, and when He heard of the gopīs’ *rasa* in all its exultation, He was delighted and danced in love.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya! Glory, glory to Nityānanda, and glory to the blessed Advaita!

3 Glory, glory to Śrīvāsa and all the devotees of Gaura! Glory to my listeners, whose treasure of life is Gaura!

4 While the Lord lay thus enraptured by love, King Pratāparudra came in.

5 On Sārvabhauma’s advice he had laid aside his royal dress, and he entered alone, dressed as a Vaiṣṇava.

6 With joined palms he asked permission of all the devotees. Then, mustering his courage, he fell down and clasped the Lord’s feet.

7 The Lord lay on the ground with His eyes closed in love, and the king skillfully massaged His feet.

8 He offered praise by reciting the verses of the *rāsa-līlā*: he recited the chapter that begins “*jayati te ’dhikam*.”

9 As the Lord listened, His joy knew no bounds. “Go on, go on!” He said again and again.

10 When the king recited the verse “*tava kathāmṛtam*,” the Lord rose in the rapture of love and embraced him.

11 “You have given Me many priceless jewels. I have nothing to give you in return, so I give you My embrace.”

12 Saying this, the Lord recited that verse again and again. Both of them trembled, and tears streamed from their eyes.

13 “The nectar of Your words is the very life of those who burn with suffering. The wise have praised it, and it takes away all sin. It is auspicious to hear, full of power and spread far and wide. Those who proclaim it on earth are the most munificent of givers” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.31.9).

14 “Most munificent! Most munificent!” cried the Lord as He embraced him. He did not know who the man was.

15 Having seen the king’s earlier service, the Lord felt mercy for him, and He bestowed His grace without asking who he was.

16 Just see how mighty Caitanya’s mercy is! Without asking anything about a person, it crowns his life with success.

17 The Lord said, “Who are you, who have done Me such good? You have come so suddenly and made Me drink the nectar of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes!”

18 The king said, “I am a servant of Your servants. Make me a servant of Your servants — that is my one hope.”

19 Then Mahāprabhu revealed His divine majesty to him and forbade him: “Tell no one.”

20 He never showed any awareness that this was the king. Within He knew everything, but outwardly He remained detached.

21 Seeing Pratāparudra’s good fortune, all the devotees praised the king with joyful hearts.

22 The king bowed down before the Lord, saluted all the devotees with joined palms and went out.

23 The Lord performed His midday duties with the devotees, and Vāṇīnātha arrived, bringing *prasāda*.

24 Through Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda and Vāṇīnātha the king had sent *prasāda* in great abundance.

25 There was the *prasāda* of the Balagaṇḍi offering, excellent and without limit, and endless *prasāda* of the dry kind, not cooked in water.

26 Curd cheese, fruit drinks, green coconuts, mangoes, ripe coconuts, jackfruits, many kinds of bananas and palm fruits.

27 Oranges, grapefruits, pomelos, tangerines and citrons; almonds, dried dates, grapes and pressed dates.

28 *Manoharā*, *laḍḍus* and a hundred other sweets; *amṛta-guṭikā* and the like, and *kṣīrsā* without measure.

29 *Amṛta-maṇḍā*, *saravatī* lemons, pumpkin shreds, *sarāmṛta*, *sarabhājā* and *sarapurī*.

30 *Hari-vallabha*, *seṅoti*, *karpūra*, *mālatī*, *ḍāli-marica laḍḍus*, *navāta* and *amṛti*.

31 *Padmacini*, *candrakānti*, *khājā*, *khaṇḍasāra*, *viyari*, *kadmā* and all kinds of sesame *khājā*.

32 There were sweets of sugar shaped like orange, grapefruit and mango trees, complete with flowers, fruits and leaves.

33 Yogurt, milk, fresh butter, buttermilk, *rasālā* and *śikhariṇī*; salted mung sprouts and sliced ginger.

34 There were many kinds of pickles, of lemons, jujubes and other fruits. I cannot write down how many kinds of *prasāda* there were.

35 Half the garden was filled with *prasāda*, and Mahāprabhu was delighted to see it.

36 Such were the meals Jagannātha takes, and the joy of seeing them soothed Mahāprabhu's eyes.

37 Five or seven loads of cups made of *ketakī* leaves were brought, so many that each person was given ten.

38 Gaurarāya knew how hard the *kīrtana* singers had labored, and He longed to feed them all.

39 He seated the devotees row by row and began to serve them Himself.

40 But no one would eat unless the Lord ate, and so Svarūpa Gosāñi made a request.

41 “Lord, please sit down Yourself and take Your meal. Unless You eat, no one can eat.”

42 Then Mahāprabhu sat down with His companions and fed them all until they were full to the throat.

43 When He had eaten and rinsed His mouth, the Lord sat down. So much *prasāda* was left over that a thousand people ate of it.

44 At the Lord’s order Govinda brought the poor and destitute, the suffering and the beggars, and fed them.

45 Gaurahari watched the beggars joyfully eating, and He instructed them to say “Hari bol!”

46 As they said “Hari bol!” the beggars floated away in love. Such wonderful pastimes Gaurarāya performs!

47 Meanwhile, at the time for Jagannātha’s chariot to move, all the *gauḍas* pulled at it, but it would not go forward.

48 Unable to pull it, the *gauḍas* let the chariot go. The king, anxious, came there with his officers and friends.

49 He set mighty wrestlers to move the chariot and put his own hand to it too, but they could not pull it.

50 Growing anxious, the king brought maddened elephants and had them harnessed to the chariot to move it.

51 The maddened elephants pulled with all their strength, but the chariot would not move a single step. It stood fixed.

52 Hearing of this, Mahāprabhu came with His companions. He stood and watched the maddened elephants pulling the chariot.

53 The elephants screamed under the blows of the goad, yet the chariot would not move, and the people cried out in dismay.

54 Then Mahāprabhu had all the elephants taken away and gave the chariot ropes to His own companions to pull.

55 He Himself pushed the chariot from behind with His head, and with a rumbling roar the chariot rushed forward.

56 The devotees simply ran along holding the ropes in their hands. The chariot moved by itself, and they had no need to pull.

57 In their joy the people shouted "*Jaya! Jaya!*" Nothing could be heard but "*Jaya Jagannātha!*"

58 In an instant the chariot reached the gate of Guṇḍicā. Seeing Caitanya's might, the people were struck with wonder.

59 "Glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya!" With such a tumult the people cried, "Blessed! Blessed!"

60 Seeing the Lord's glory, Pratāparudra, his officers and his friends thrilled with love in every limb.

61 Then the servants performed the *Pāṇḍu-vijaya*, and Jagannātha went and sat upon His throne.

62 Subhadrā and Balarāma came to their thrones too, and Jagannātha's bathing and offerings began.

63 In the courtyard Mahāprabhu and the devotees joyfully began to dance and sing *kīrtana*.

64 In His joy Mahāprabhu's love surged up, and all who saw Him floated in the ocean of love.

65 After the dance He watched the evening *ārati*. Then the Lord came to Āiṭoṭā and rested.

66 Advaita and the other devotees invited the Lord: the nine chief devotees received the nine days.

67 The other devotees divided up all the days of the Cāturmāsya, one day each.

68 The chief devotees divided up the days of the four months among themselves, and the other devotees found no opportunity.

69 So two or three of them would join together to invite Him for a single day. Such was Mahāprabhu's pastime of invitations.

70 In the morning He bathed and saw Jagannātha, and then He danced in *saṅkīrtana* with the devotees.

71 Sometimes He made Advaita dance, sometimes Nityānanda; sometimes Haridāsa, sometimes Acyutānanda.

72 Sometimes He made Vakreśvara dance, and sometimes other devotees. Three times a day He held *kīrtana* in the courtyard of Guṇḍicā.

73 The Lord felt that Kṛṣṇa had come back to Vṛndāvana, and His feeling of separation from Kṛṣṇa came to an end.

74 His mind was filled with Kṛṣṇa's pastimes with Rādhā, and the Lord Himself became immersed in this *rasa*.

75 In the various gardens He enacted the pastimes of Vṛndāvana with the devotees, and in the Indradyumna lake He sported in the water.

76 The Lord Himself splashed all the devotees with water, and they all surrounded Him and splashed Him from every side.

77 Sometimes they formed one circle and sometimes many, and all of them clapped their palms on the water, making a sound like frogs croaking.

78 Pairing off two by two, they fought water battles; some lost and some won, and the Lord looked on.

79 Advaita and Nityānanda threw water at each other. The Ācārya lost, and then began to hurl abuse.

80 Vidyānidhi played in the water with Svarūpa, and the two, Gupta and Datta, played together.

81 Gadādhara played in the water with Śrīvāsa, and Vakreśvara with Rāghava Paṇḍita.

82 Rāmānanda Rāya played with Sārvabhauma. Both of them lost all their gravity and became like children.

83 Seeing those two frolicking, Mahāprabhu smiled and said to Gopīnātha Ācārya:

84 "Both are learned, grave and respected men, yet they are frolicking like children. Make them stop."

85 Gopīnātha said, “When a single drop of the great ocean of Your mercy overflows,

86 it drowns even the mountains Meru and Mandara wherever they stand. What then of these two, who are mere hillocks?

87 He spent his whole life eating the oilcake of dry logic, and now You make him drink the nectar of pastimes. This is Your mercy.”

88 Smiling, Mahāprabhu then brought Advaita and made Him His couch, like Śeṣa, upon the water.

89 He lay down upon Him, and so the Lord revealed the pastime of the One who lies on Śeṣa.

90 Advaita revealed His own power: carrying Mahāprabhu, He floated about on the water.

91 After sporting in the water like this for some time, the Lord returned to Āiṭoṭā with the devotees.

92 Purī, Bhāratī and all the other chief devotees took their meal at the Ācārya’s invitation.

93 All the rest of the *prasāda* that Vāṇīnātha brought was eaten by Mahāprabhu’s companions.

94 In the afternoon He came, took *darśana* and danced, and at night He returned to the garden to rest.

95 The next day He came again to see the Lord, and for some time He danced and sang in the courtyard.

96 Then the Lord came to the garden with the devotees and enjoyed the pastimes of Vṛndāvana with them.

97 At the sight of the Lord the trees and creepers burst into bloom, the bees and cuckoos sang, and a cool breeze blew.

98 The Lord danced beneath every tree, while Vāsudeva Datta alone sang.

99 Beneath each tree he sang a new song, and Gaurarāya danced alone in supreme ecstasy.

100 Then the Lord told Vakreśvara to dance. Vakreśvara danced, and the Lord began to sing.

101 Svarūpa and the other singers sang with the Lord. In the flood of love they lost all sense of direction.

102 After enjoying the pastimes of the forest like this for some time, they went to the Narendra lake to play in the water.

103 After sporting in the water, the Lord came back to the garden and enjoyed the pastime of eating with the devotees.

104 For nine days Jagannātha stays at Guṇḍicā, and all that time Mahāprabhu enjoyed such pastimes with the devotees.

105 There is a large flower garden called Jagannātha-vallabha, and the Lord rested there for those nine days.

106 Knowing that the day of the Herā-pañcamī had come, the king spoke to Kāśī Miśra with great care.

107 “Tomorrow is the Herā-pañcamī, the procession of Lakṣmī. Hold the festival as it has never been held before.

108 Prepare the great festival with such splendor that Mahāprabhu will be struck with wonder when He sees it.

109 From the Deity’s storehouse and from mine take colored cloths, small bells, umbrellas and *cāmaras*.

110 Decorate everything with flags, banners and bells, and adorn the palanquin procession with music and dancing of every kind.

111 Make all the offerings double, so that the festival is more wonderful than the Ratha-yātrā.

112 And arrange it so that the Lord and His devotees can come freely and take *darśana*.”

113 In the morning Mahāprabhu went with His companions to Sundarācala and took *darśana* of Jagannātha.

114 Then He came back to Nīlācala with the devotees, eager to see the festivities of the Herā-pañcamī.

115 Kāśī Miśra received the Lord with great honor and seated Him with His companions in a good place.

116 The Lord wished to hear about a special *rasa*, and with a slight smile He asked Svarūpa:

117–118 “Jagannātha enjoys His pastimes in Dvārakā, and there He naturally shows His supreme magnanimity. Still, once a year He feels a boundless longing to see Vṛndāvana.

119 These gardens are like Vṛndāvana, and His heart longs to see them.

120 Outwardly He makes the Ratha-yātrā His pretext: the Lord leaves Nīlācala and goes to Sundarācala.

121 There He plays night and day in the many flower gardens. Why, then, does He not take Lakṣmī-devī with Him?"

122 Svarūpa said, "Hear the reason for this, Lord. Lakṣmī has no right to enter the pastimes of Vṛndāvana.

123 In the pastimes of Vṛndāvana Kṛṣṇa's companions are the gopīs. No one but the gopīs can steal Kṛṣṇa's heart."

124 The Lord said, "Kṛṣṇa goes on the pretext of the festival, and with Him go two: Subhadrā and Baladeva.

125 All the pastimes He enjoys with the gopīs in the gardens remain hidden: no one knows Kṛṣṇa's secret heart.

126 So there is no fault at all in what Kṛṣṇa openly does. Why, then, is Lakṣmī-devī so angry?"

127 Svarūpa said, "This is the very nature of a woman in love: at the slightest trace of indifference from her beloved, anger arises in her."

128 Just then Lakṣmī-devī set out, mounted on a golden palanquin inlaid with jewels of every kind.

129 There were multitudes of umbrellas, *cāmaras*, standards and flags, and ahead of the many musical instruments danced the temple dancers (*deva-dāsīs*).

130 Hundreds of maidservants accompanied her with betel boxes, water jugs, fans and *cāmaras*, wearing necklaces and divine ornaments and garments.

131 With great splendor and a large retinue, Lakṣmī-devī came in anger to the Lion Gate.

132 Lakṣmī-devī's maidservants seized all of Jagannātha's chief servants and bound them.

133 Having bound them, they brought them and threw them down at Lakṣmī's feet. They punished them like thieves, as if to exact all kinds of riches from them.

134 They beat them until they were nearly senseless and heaped all kinds of abuse and mockery on them.

135 Seeing the boldness of Lakṣmī's maidservants, Mahāprabhu's associates laughed, covering their mouths with their hands.

136 Svarūpa Dāmodara said, "Where in the three worlds does one see *māna*, loving pique, of this kind? I have never heard of such a thing.

137 A woman in *māna* dejectedly lays aside her ornaments; she sits on the ground, her face clouded, and draws lines on it with her nails.

138 I have heard before of such *māna* in Satyabhāmā; but in Vraja the *māna* of the gopīs is a treasure-house of *rasa*.

139 This goddess, however, displays all her wealth and marches against her beloved with an army in battle array!"

140 The Lord said, “Tell Me about the kinds of *māna* in Vraja.” Svarūpa replied, “The river of the gopīs’ *māna* flows in a hundred streams.

141 The natures of the heroines differ greatly, and so do the ways their love behaves; according to these differences, *māna* appears in many forms.

142 The gopīs’ *māna* cannot be described in full; I shall only point the way with one or two of its varieties.

143 In *māna* some are *dhīrā*, composed; some are *adhīrā*, impetuous; and some, making the third division, are *dhīrādhīrā*, both composed and impetuous.

144 Seeing her lover from afar, the composed heroine rises to greet him, and when he comes near she offers him a seat.

145 Anger lies in her heart, but her lips speak sweet words; when her beloved embraces her, she embraces him in return.

146 Her behavior is straightforward, yet she nurses her *māna*; or else she rebuffs her beloved with ironic words.

147 The impetuous heroine scolds her lover with harsh words; she strikes him with the lotus from her ear or binds him with her garland.

148 The heroine who is both composed and impetuous mocks him with crooked words: at times she praises him, at times she reproaches him, and at times she is indifferent.

149 There are three kinds of heroine: *mugdhā* (artless), *madhyā* (intermediate) and *pragalbhā* (bold). The artless heroine does not know the artful ways of *māna*.

150 She only covers her face and weeps, and when she hears her lover's tender words, she is pacified.

151 The intermediate and the bold heroines take on the divisions of *dhīrā* and the rest, and among all of them there are three kinds by nature.

152 Some are *prakharā*, sharp; some are *mṛdu*, gentle; and some are *samā*, balanced. Each, by her own nature, expands the bounds of Kṛṣṇa's love.

153 Sharpness, gentleness and a balanced nature are all faultless, and by each of these natures they delight Kṛṣṇa."

154 Hearing this, the Lord felt boundless bliss. "Go on, go on, Dāmodara!" He said again and again.

155 Dāmodara said, "Kṛṣṇa is the crown of all who relish *rasa*. He tastes *rasa*, and His very body is made of *rasa*.

156 Kṛṣṇa's form is made of love, and He is subject to the love of His devotees. In pure love and in the qualities of *rasa* the gopīs are supremely expert.

157 In the gopīs' love there is no fault of *rasābhāsa*, a mere semblance of *rasa*; therefore it gives Kṛṣṇa supreme satisfaction."

158 "Thus Kṛṣṇa, whose desires are ever true, surrounded by the maidens devoted to Him and keeping His amorous feelings within Himself, enjoyed all those nights resplendent with moonlight — the autumn nights that are the abode of the *rasa* told in poetry." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.33.25)

159 "One group of gopīs is *vāmā*, contrary, and another is *dakṣiṇā*, compliant. Through their various moods they let Kṛṣṇa taste *rasa*.

160 Among the gopīs the foremost is Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī, a mine of the jewels of love in the pure and radiant *rasa* (*ujjvala-rasa*).

161 In age She is *madhyā*, in the bloom of youth; by nature She is *samā*, balanced; yet in the depth of Her love She is always *vāmā*, contrary.

162 From Her contrary nature *māna* constantly arises, and in the midst of it the ocean of Kṛṣṇa's bliss rises."

163 "Like the movement of a snake, the course of love is winding by nature. Therefore pique (*māna*) arises between the young lovers, with cause and without cause." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Śṛṅgāra-bheda-kathana, 102)[1]

164 Hearing this, the ocean of the Lord's bliss swelled. "Go on, go on," the Lord said, and Dāmodara continued:

165 "Rādhikā's love is *adhirūḍha mahābhāva*, the highest summit of *mahābhāva*. It is utterly pure and spotless, like gold refined in fire.

166 Whenever She suddenly catches sight of Kṛṣṇa, She becomes adorned with the ornaments of many *bhāvas*, ecstatic feelings.

167 Hers are the eight *sāttvika* transformations, the *vyabhicārī-bhāvas* beginning with joy, Her natural love and the twenty ornaments of *bhāva*:

168 *kila-kiñcita*, *kuṭṭamita*, *vilāsa*, *lalita*, *vivvoka*, *moṭṭāyita*, *maugdhya*, *cakita* and others.

169 When Kṛṣṇa sees Śrī Rādhā's form adorned with so many ornaments of *bhāva*, the waves of the ocean of His happiness surge high.

170 Now hear a description of *kila-kiñcita* and the other *bhāvas*, the ornaments of feeling by which Rādhā steals Kṛṣṇa's mind.

171 When Kṛṣṇa sees Rādhā and wants to touch Her, when He bars Her way on the path to the toll crossing (*dāna-ghāṭi*),

172 when He comes and forbids Her to pick flowers, or when He tries to touch Her in front of Her friends —

173 in all these situations *kila-kiñcita* arises. Its root cause is the *sañcārī-bhāva* of joy (*harṣa*), which comes first.

174 "The mingling of pride, longing, weeping, smiling, envy, fear and anger, born of joy, is called *kila-kiñcita*." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Vibhāva-kathana, 71)

175 The other seven *bhāvas* come and naturally combine with joy, and from the union of these eight *bhāvas* arises *mahābhāva*.

176 The seven are pride, longing, fear, tearless weeping, anger, envy and a faint smile.

177 These eight *bhāvas*, each of a different flavor, meet in one, and in tasting that blend Kṛṣṇa's mind is fully satisfied.

178 It is like *rasālā*, which is so sweet because yogurt, sugar, ghee, honey, black pepper, camphor and cardamom are blended in it.

179 Seeing Rādhā's face and eyes filled with these *bhāvas*, Kṛṣṇa feels ten million times more happiness than in union with Her.

180 "When Mādhava stopped Rādhā on the path, Her glance shone with a smile held within; its lashes were strewn with tears and its corners slightly

reddened; brimming with playful delight, it narrowed, its pupils sweetly curving upward. May that glance of Rādhā's, a bouquet of *kila-kiñcita*, bestow good fortune on you." (Dāna-keli-kaumudī 1)

181 "Seeing Rādhā's face adorned with *kila-kiñcita* — Her restless eyes clouded with tears and reddened at the corners, Her face alight with *rasa*, Her lips trembling with playful delight, Her brows arched and a smile dawning — Kṛṣṇa attained a bliss ten million times greater than that of union with Her, a bliss beyond the reach of words." (Govinda-līlāmṛta 9.18)

182 Hearing this, the Lord rejoiced at heart, and, absorbed in happiness, He embraced Svarūpa.

183 "Now tell Me the characteristics of *vilāsa* and the other ornaments of *bhāva* by which Rādhā steals Govinda's mind."

184 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi began to speak, and the Lord's devotees were overjoyed to hear him.

185 "Rādhā may be sitting, or going into the forest of Vṛndāvana, when suddenly She catches sight of Kṛṣṇa.

186 On seeing Him, various *bhāvas* appear in Her in an extraordinary way, and that distinctiveness is called the ornament of *vilāsa*.

187 "The momentary distinctiveness in a heroine's gait, standing, sitting and so on, and in the movements of her face, eyes and other features, born of meeting her beloved, is called *vilāsa*." (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Vibhāva-kathana, 67)

188 Shyness, joy, longing, flurry, contrariness and fear — all these *bhāvas* combine and make Rādhā restless.

189 “When She saw Kṛṣṇa before Her, Her gait halted and wavered; Her lovely face turned aside, half covered by Her dark veil; and Her wide eyes curved, their pupils darting. Thus, adorned with Her own ornament called *vilāsa*, She became Her beloved’s delight.” (Govinda-līlāmṛta 9.11)

190 When Rādhā stands before Kṛṣṇa, She stands with Her body bent in three places, making Her brows dance.

191 When Her face and eyes pour forth many *bhāvas*, this mood of the beloved heroine is called the ornament of *lalita*.

192 “Where the poise of the limbs is graceful and delicate, charming with the play of the brows, that is called *lalita*.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Vibhāva-kathana, 75)

193 When Kṛṣṇa sees Rādhā adorned with *lalita*, They both long to meet each other.

194 “Bashfully turning Her neck aside and bending Her feet and waist, She looked most charming; the moving creepers of Her brows broke the mighty bow of Kāmadeva; Her graceful, cherished body glowed with the joy of love for Her beloved. Thus, for Her beloved’s delight, She was adorned with the ornament of *lalita*, which had arisen in Her.” (Govinda-līlāmṛta 9.14)

195 When Kṛṣṇa eagerly comes and pulls at Her bodice (*kañcuka*), Rādhā is delighted within, yet She wards Him off.

196 Outwardly She shows contrariness and anger, but inwardly She is happy at heart. Among the ornaments this *bhāva* is called *kuṭṭamita*.

197 “When her breasts, lips and so on are touched, the heroine, though joyful at heart, shows anger outwardly in her agitation, as if she were

pained. The wise call this *kuṭṭamita*.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Anubhāva-prakaraṇa, 49)

198 She checks Kṛṣṇa’s hand, and yet His desire is fulfilled; within, Rādhā feels bliss, while outwardly She shows contrariness and anger.

199 As if in pain, She weeps without tears, and with a faint smile She rebukes Kṛṣṇa.

200 “Rādhā, whose thighs are like an elephant’s trunk, checks Mādhava’s hand without obstructing His desire; She rebukes Him with a sweet smile hidden in Her words; and on Her face there is a charming, tearless weeping.”

201 In the same way there are all the other ornaments of *bhāva*; adorned with them, Rādhā steals Kṛṣṇa’s mind.

202 Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes are endless; they cannot be described in full, even if the thousand-mouthed Ananta Himself describes them.”

203 Śrīvāsa said with a smile, “Listen, Dāmodara! See the abundant wealth of my Lakṣmī!

204 And see the wealth of Vṛndāvana: flowers and young shoots, mountain minerals, peacock feathers and *guñjā* berries!

205 Jagannātha went to see Vṛndāvana, and when Lakṣmī-devī heard of it, she grew uneasy at heart.

206 ‘Why did He leave so much wealth and go to Vṛndāvana?’ Lakṣmī thought, and to make Him a laughingstock she arrayed herself in all her splendor.

207 ‘Look at your master! He has left all this wealth and gone to a flower garden, greedy for leaves, fruits and flowers.

208 Where would the crown jewel of the clever do such a thing? Bring your master before Lakṣmī!’

209 Saying this, all of Mahā-Lakṣmī’s maidservants bound the Lord’s own servants with waistcloths and brought them before her.

210 They brought them to Lakṣmī’s feet and made them bow down; they exacted a fine from them and made them plead humbly.

211 They beat the chariot with sticks and treated Jagannātha’s servants almost like thieves.

212 All the servants said with folded hands, ‘Tomorrow we shall bring Jagannātha before you.’

213 Then Lakṣmī, pacified, went back to her own home. The wealth of my Lakṣmī is beyond words!

214 Your gopīs boil milk and churn yogurt, while my mistress sits on a jeweled throne.”

215 Śrīvāsa, whose nature is like Nārada’s, joked in this way, and all of Mahāprabhu’s own servants laughed to hear him.

216 The Lord said, “Śrīvāsa, you have Nārada’s nature: in the mood of majesty (*aiśvarya*), the Lord’s power holds sway over you.

217 But this Svarūpa Dāmodara is a pure resident of Vraja. Floating in pure love, he does not know majesty.”

218 Svarūpa said, “Śrīvāsa, listen carefully! Does the wealth of Vṛndāvana not come to your mind?

219 In Vṛndāvana there is a natural ocean of wealth, and the wealth of Dvārakā and Vaikuṇṭha is but a drop of it.

220 The Supreme Person, Bhagavān Himself, Kṛṣṇa, is the master of wealth in the abode of Vṛndāvana.

221 There the ground is made of *cintāmaṇi* gems and the houses of jewels; *cintāmaṇi* gems are the ornaments on the maidservants’ feet.

222 There the natural forest is made of wish-fulfilling trees and creepers, yet no one asks them for any wealth but flowers and fruits.

223 Countless wish-fulfilling cows wander there from forest to forest; they give only milk, and no one asks them for any other wealth.

224 There the ordinary talk of the people is a divine song, and their ordinary walking seems like dancing.

225 Everywhere there the water is like nectar, and the light of spiritual bliss is embodied there and relished.

226 There the company of Lakṣmīs, the gopīs, surpass Lakṣmī in their qualities, and Kṛṣṇa’s flute serves as a dear friend.

227 “There the beloveds are goddesses of fortune and the lover is the Supreme Person; the trees are wish-fulfilling trees; the ground is made of *cintāmaṇi* gems and the water is nectar; speech is song and walking is dance; the flute is a dear friend; and the supreme light of spiritual bliss is there to be relished.” (Brahma-saṁhitā 5.56)

228 “In Vṛndāvana *cintāmaṇi* is the ornament of the maidens’ feet; the trees of the gods are trees that yield flowers for their adornment; and the wealth of Vraja is herds of wish-fulfilling cows. Ah, this splendor is an ocean of happiness!” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 2.1.173)

229 Hearing this, Śrīvāsa danced in the rapture of love, clapping his hands under his arms and laughing loudly.

230 The Lord heard of Rādhā’s pure *rasa* in rapture, and in that rapture of *rasa* He began to dance.

231 Absorbed in *rasa*, the Lord danced and Svarūpa sang. “Go on, go on!” the Lord said, lending His ears.

232 Hearing songs of the *rasa* of Vraja, His love surged up, and the Lord flooded the town of Puruṣottama with love.

233 In due time Lakṣmī-devī went back to her own home. The Lord went on dancing, and the second watch of the day (*prahara*) had come.

234 The four groups grew very tired from singing, but Mahāprabhu’s rapture of love doubled.

235 In the rapture of Rādhā’s love the Lord assumed Her very form. Seeing this from afar, Nityānanda offered prayers.

236 Seeing the Lord’s rapture, Nityānanda would not come near but kept somewhat at a distance.

237 Who but Nityānanda could hold the Lord? His rapture did not subside, and the *kīrtana* did not stop.

238 By a skillful hint Svarūpa made the Lord aware of everyone's fatigue, and seeing how tired the devotees were, the Lord returned to outer awareness.

239 Taking all the devotees with Him, the Lord went to the flower garden; there He rested and then took His midday bath.

240 Many offerings of Jagannātha's *prasāda* arrived, and Lakṣmī's *prasāda* of various kinds arrived too.

241 With everyone around Him, the Lord ate joyfully. After His evening bath He went for *darśana* of Jagannātha.

242 Seeing Jagannātha, He danced and sang *kīrtana*; then He played in the water of Narendra Lake with the devotees.

243 Coming to the garden, He had a meal in the grove. In this way the Lord enjoyed His pastimes for eight days.

244 The next day was Jagannātha's return (*bhitara-vijaya*): mounting His chariot, Jagannātha went back to His own abode.

245 As before, the Lord, together with the devotees, danced and sang *kīrtana* in supreme bliss.

246 Once again Jagannātha's *pāṇḍu-vijaya* took place, and one of the silk ropes broke.

247 The cotton pads used for the *pāṇḍu-vijaya* tore and burst, and under Jagannātha's weight the cotton flew up and scattered.

248 Rāmānanda and Satyarāja Khān of Kulīna-grāma were there, and the Lord respectfully gave them an order:

249 “You be the patrons (*yajamāna*) of these silk ropes. Every year have the ropes made and bring them.”

250 So saying, He gave them the torn silk rope. “Look at this,” He said, “and make the ropes very strong.

251 In this silk rope resides Śeṣa, who serves Bhagavān by assuming ten forms.”

252 Fortunate indeed were Satyarāja and Rāmānanda: receiving the order to serve, they felt supreme bliss.

253 Every year after that, they came with the devotees to the Guṇḍicā festival with great joy, bringing silk ropes.

254 Then Jagannātha went and sat upon His throne, and Mahāprabhu came home with the devotees.

255 In this way the Lord showed the devotees the Ratha-yātrā festival and, together with them, enacted the pastimes of Vṛndāvana.

256 The pastimes of Caitanya Gosāñi are endless and boundless; even the thousand-mouthed Śeṣa cannot reach their end.

257 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[2]

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 8.110; translation as there. ↩
2. The same colophon as Madhya 7.155; translation as there. ↩